ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 05

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The Spinifex people have lived in the Great Australian Desert for more than —

(A) 250 years (B) 2,500 years (C) 2 lakh years (D) 25,000 years

Ans: (D) They are among the oldest continuing cultures and their way of life is being preserved.

(ii) In India, the Prime Minister is appointed by the —

(A) Chief Justice of India (B) President
(C) Speaker of the Lok Sabha (D) Election Commission

Ans: (B) The President invites the leader who commands majority support in the Lok Sabha.

(iii) At the start of the Quit India Movement in 1942, the Congress flag at Gowalia Tank Maidan, Mumbai, was hoisted by —

(A) Sarojini Naidu (B) Aruna Asaf Ali (C) Kanaklata Barua (D) Annie Besant

Ans: (B) Top leaders had been arrested, and she became a symbol of the movement.

(iv) The Mehrangarh Fort, built of local red sandstone, overlooks the city of —

(A) Jaipur (B) Bikaner (C) Udaipur (D) Jodhpur

Ans: (D) It stands on a hill; its palace is now a museum.

(v) A High Court judge retires at the age of —

(A) 62 years (B) 58 years (C) 65 years (D) 70 years

Ans: (A) A Supreme Court judge retires at 65.

(vi) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Fundamental Rights such as freedom of speech are subject to reasonable restrictions.
Statement II: The right to freedom of religion allows a person to force others to follow his or her religion.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

Ans: (A) No one can be forced to follow, spread or fund a particular religion.

(vii) A population pyramid with a narrow base and a bulging middle indicates that —

(A) there are many children and very few adults
(B) everyone is elderly
(C) birth rates are falling and the working-age group is large
(D) the population is falling rapidly

Ans: (C) India's pyramid is moving towards this bell shape.

(viii) Which NCR city became a major hub for Business Process Outsourcing (BPO)?

(A) Meerut (B) Rohtak (C) Alwar (D) Gurugram

Ans: (D) BPO means hiring another firm to handle some business functions.

(ix) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): Over-fishing threatens the survival of many fish species.
Reason (R): Fish are harvested faster than they can regenerate.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R explains A: when catch exceeds regeneration, stocks decline.

(x) The Ahom kingdom, ruled for about six centuries, was located in the —

(A) Ganga valley
(B) Konkan coast
(C) Brahmaputra valley (Assam)
(D) Deccan plateau

> **Ans: (C)** Lachit Borphukan defended it at Saraighat.

(xi) The Peshwas of the Maratha state were —

(A) Mughal governors
(B) hereditary prime ministers
(C) tax collectors
(D) temple priests only

> **Ans: (B)** After Shivaji's grandson, the Peshwas became the effective rulers.

(xii) After the Revolt of 1857, the rule of India passed from the East India Company to —

(A) the British Crown
(B) the Mughal emperor
(C) the Marathas
(D) the Indian National Congress

> **Ans: (A)** The Government of India was taken over in 1858.

(xiii) The NOTA option on an EVM allows a voter to —

(A) reject all the candidates if he or she does not like any
(B) vote twice
(C) change the symbol
(D) cast a vote by post

> **Ans: (A)** NOTA stands for 'None of the Above'.

(xiv) Soil, water, forests and minerals belong to which factor of production?

(A) Labour
(B) Land
(C) Capital
(D) Entrepreneurship

> **Ans: (B)** Land means all natural resources.

(xv) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): Words like 'kitāb' and 'dukān' are found in many Indian languages today.
Reason (R): Persian was the language of administration and the court for centuries, so its words entered regional languages.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R explains A: long use of Persian in public life left its words behind.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Who was Tarabai? Why is she remembered in Maratha history?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Widow of Chhatrapati Rajaram; acted as regent for her young son — 1 mark
> - Led the Maratha resistance against Aurangzeb after 1700 — 1 mark

O R

2.(B) Who was Lachit Borphukan and what was his victory?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A commander of the Ahom army — 1 mark
> - He defeated a larger Mughal force at the Battle of Saraighat (1671) — 1 mark

3. Distinguish between a citizen and a resident of a country.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Citizen — a formal legal member of the country with rights and duties — 1 mark
> - Resident — a person who merely lives in a place and may not be a citizen — 1 mark

4.(A) What was the Lucknow Pact of 1916?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - An agreement between the Congress and the Muslim League — 1 mark
> - Both demanded self-government; the Congress accepted separate electorates for Muslims — 1 mark

O R

4.(B) What was the Rowlatt Act and why was it opposed?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A law of 1919 that allowed detention without trial — 1 mark
> - It took away basic freedoms and led to protests and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre — 1 mark

5. Explain the difference between the head of state and the head of government in India.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - President is the head of state — the formal head of the country — 1 mark
> - Prime Minister is the head of government, who leads the Council of Ministers and runs the administration — 1 mark

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Explain any three problems created by an ageing population.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - More demand for health care and special services
> - Fewer workers compared with dependent elderly people
> - Pension burden on governments
> - Slower economic growth and labour shortage

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6.(B) Suggest any three ways in which cities can become more sustainable.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Efficient public transport and cycling or pedestrian streets
- More trees, parks and green roofs
- Waste segregation, recycling and rainwater harvesting
- Clean energy and flexible master plans with citizen participation

7.(A) State any three ways in which British land-revenue policies harmed Indian peasants.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- High revenue demands, even in bad harvest years
- Peasants fell into debt to moneylenders
- Many lost their land when they could not pay
- Forced cultivation of cash crops like indigo

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7.(B) State any three advantages of using EVMs in elections.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Counting is faster and results come quickly
- Invalid and doubtful votes are avoided
- Easy to carry and use in remote areas
- With VVPAT, the voter can verify the vote

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Describe the Swadeshi Movement and the Partition of Bengal (1905) under the following points: causes, methods, leaders and results.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Lord Curzon partitioned Bengal in 1905, seen as an attempt to divide and weaken nationalism
- Indians boycotted British goods and used swadeshi products
- Public meetings, processions and national schools spread the message
- Leaders included Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal, Lala Lajpat Rai and Aurobindo Ghosh
- Protests spread beyond Bengal
- Partition was annulled in 1911, but a stronger national feeling had been created

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8.(B) Explain how oceans influence climate and trade with examples such as the Gulf Stream, the Suez Canal and the Persian Gulf.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Oceans cover about 71 per cent of the Earth and absorb and release heat, regulating climate
- They add moisture to the air, forming clouds and rainfall
- Warm and cold currents change coastal climates — the Gulf Stream warms Western Europe
- The Suez Canal (1869) gives the shortest sea route from India to Europe
- The Persian Gulf and bays like the Bay of Bengal provide sheltered ports for trade
- Oceans also provide food, oxygen (through plankton) and transport routes

9. Describe the rise of Maratha power under Shivaji up to his coronation in 1674.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Born in 1630 at Shivneri; began by capturing hill forts like Torna
- Used guerrilla tactics and knowledge of the hills and forts
- Killed the Bijapur general Afzal Khan at Pratapgad
- Treaty of Purandar (1665) with the Mughals; escaped from Agra in 1666
- Built a strong army and navy; organised the Ashta Pradhan council
- Crowned Chhatrapati at Raigad in 1674

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> On the evening of 8 August 1942, Gandhi addressed a huge crowd at Gowalia Tank Maidan in Bombay. He told them to act on a simple mantra — 'Do or Die'. Within hours of the Quit India resolution, the top Congress leaders, including Gandhi, were arrested. Without leaders, ordinary people took over the movement: there were strikes, protests and attacks on government offices. Though crushed by force, the movement showed that the demand for freedom could no longer be ignored.

(10.1) What was Gandhi's mantra during the Quit India Movement?

'Do or Die'.

(10.2) What happened to the top Congress leaders soon after the resolution?

They were arrested.

(10.3) State two reasons why Quit India is considered a turning point.

(1) People led the movement themselves when leaders were jailed; (1) it showed British rule could not continue for long and widespread support for independence.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The river Kaveri flows through Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry. Its water is used for farming, drinking and generating power in all these places. In years of poor rainfall, the states often disagree about how much water each should receive. Such rivers can only be managed through cooperation among the states that share them.

(11.1) Name two of the states or Union Territories through which the Kaveri flows.

Any two of: Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Puducherry.

(11.2) Why do disputes about river water arise in years of low rainfall?

Water becomes scarce while demand for farming, drinking and power remains high.

(11.3) Suggest two ways of resolving such disputes.

Any two (1 mark each): negotiation among states; a tribunal or court; scientific sharing of water by need and availability; saving water and efficient irrigation.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In the 1970s the white marble of the Taj Mahal began to turn yellowish. Experts traced the problem to pollution from industries around Agra, which burned coal and other fossil fuels. Following a public interest petition and the work of an expert committee, polluting industries near the monument were controlled in the mid-1990s. Protecting such heritage is also the Fundamental Duty of every citizen.

(12.1) What was happening to the Taj Mahal's marble in the 1970s?

It was turning yellowish.

(12.2) What was the main cause of this damage?

Air pollution from industries burning coal and other fossil fuels.

(12.3) State one legal step and one thing citizens can do to protect heritage monuments.

(1) PIL / expert committee and a ban or control on polluting industries; (1) citizens can avoid littering or defacing, report damage, and spread awareness (Fundamental Duty to value heritage).

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> India's child mortality — the number of children who die before the age of five for every 1,000 born — was 271 in 1950. By 2023 it had fallen to 28. Better health care, vaccination, clean drinking water and education of mothers all helped. As more children survived, India's population grew rapidly for several decades before birth rates also began to fall.

(13.1) By how much per 1,000 did child mortality fall between 1950 and 2023?

> 271 − 28 = 243 per 1,000.

(13.2) State one reason for this fall.

> Any one: better health care; vaccination; clean drinking water; education of mothers.

(13.3) How did the fall in child mortality affect India's population growth in the following decades? Explain in two points.

> (1) More children survived to become adults, so the population grew quickly while birth rates remained high; (1) later, with confidence in child survival and education, families chose to have fewer children and growth slowed.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Dandi
(II) Nalanda
(III) Bhubaneswar (Khorda region)
(IV) Sambalpur
(V) Lucknow
(VI) Hyderabad

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Dandi located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Nalanda located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bhubaneswar located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Sambalpur located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Lucknow located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Hyderabad located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Dandi — **Gujarat**
- (II) Nalanda — **Bihar**
- (III) Bhubaneswar (Khorda region) — **Odisha**
- (IV) Sambalpur — **Odisha**
- (V) Lucknow — **Uttar Pradesh**
- (VI) Hyderabad — **Telangana**

